

Halden Distribution Ltd. — Endpoint change: what is changing and what you will notice

Prepared by: Muhammad Ibrahim Akmal, IT · **For:** All staff · **Date:** 2026-10-02 **Change:** CHG-2026-004 (endpoint hardening) · **Change record:** p04-change-record.md **User runbook:** ../docs/runbooks/user-device-blocked.md

What is changing

Halden's PCs have never had a written standard. We are putting one in place, so that a lost laptop is not a data breach and a single infected PC cannot spread to the whole company. In practice, four things change for you:

- 1. **Your disk gets encrypted** (BitLocker). If the device is ever lost or stolen, the data on it cannot be read by whoever finds it.
- 1. **You will not have administrator rights on the PC.** Software you need is installed by IT. Most software requests are handled the same day, and there is a clear process (below).
- 1. **Email attachments and Office macros cannot run programs.** This is the main way ransomware gets into a small business. If you have a genuine business macro, tell us and we will handle it individually rather than switching the protection off for everyone.
- 1. **Your device is checked automatically every day** against nine security controls. IT sees the result, so problems are found before they become incidents.

Why it matters to the business

Risk today	After this change
A lost or stolen laptop means Halden's data is gone with it	The disk is encrypted, so the data cannot be read from the device
Anyone can install anything and can turn protections off	Only IT can change protections, and every change is logged
One infected PC can spread through the company	Malicious behaviour in email attachments, macros and scripts is blocked
Nobody can say whether our devices are secure	One daily percentage, per control, that management can track over time

What you will notice, and when

When	What you will see
During the rollout	One or two restarts, in a window agreed with your team

When	What you will see
If a file or macro is blocked	A message saying it was blocked by your organisation. See the runbook; it is usually a phishing attempt, and there is a proper way to get a legitimate file reviewed
If you try to install software	Windows asks for administrator permission. That is expected — raise a request instead
If your device ever asks for a BitLocker recovery key	Call the Service Desk. Your identity will be checked before anyone helps, which is deliberate
Day to day	Nothing else changes. Your files, drives, printers and applications work as before

What you need to do

1. **Nothing on day one.** Keep working as normal.
 2. **Save your work before the agreed restart** for your team's rollout window.
 3. **If you need software**, raise a ticket with the software name, what you need it for, and any deadline. Your manager approves it, and IT installs it in the safest way. See section below.
1. **If something that used to work stops working**, tell the Service Desk. Do not look for a workaround
— a workaround hides a real problem that we need to fix.

Requesting software (the simple version)

1. **Raise a ticket** — software name, what it is for, deadline.
 2. **Your manager approves** it as a business need.
 3. **IT installs it** with the rights it needs. In most cases that is the whole story, and you never need administrator rights yourself.
1. **For a one-off task**, IT can grant a permission that expires by itself, rather than giving you permanent rights.
1. **You will always get an answer, and a reason if the answer is no.**

Who to contact

Situation	Contact
Software request, blocked file, blocked macro	IT Service Desk (ticket)
BitLocker recovery screen	IT Service Desk (phone), urgent — have your staff ID ready
Anything business-stopping	IT Service Desk (phone), marked "urgent"

Rollback

Every phase was snapshotted before it ran, and any control can be returned to a logging-only mode within minutes. If something in this change stops legitimate work, tell us: the control will be adapted so

the business can carry on safely, rather than being switched off for everybody.

Lab note: Halden Distribution Ltd. is a fictional company used for a home-lab portfolio project. This is the staff-facing brief that accompanies the change.

Halden Distribution Ltd. — home-lab portfolio artifact (fictional company, real configurations). Generated from p04-user-comms.md on 2026-10-02.